XINYU ZHANG

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EDUCATION

- **University of Chicago** **GPA:** 3.96/4.00
  Master of Arts, Economics Concentration (Research Track), *June 2025*
  Selected Coursework: PhD Math Camp; Intro to Empirical Analysis; Causal Inference; Econometrics and Machine Learning; Intro to Economic Design; Macroeconomics; Optimization
- **University of Chinese Academy of Social Sciences** (UCASS) **Average:** 91.5/100 **Rank:** 1/56
  Bachelor of Economics, *June 2024, Academic Supervisor: Prof. Wenshu Gao*
  Selected Coursework: Math: Calculus; Linear Algebra; Probability and Statistics; **Econ:** Intermediate Micro-/Macro-; Intro to Advanced Micro-; Econometrics; Public Econ; **Coding:** Python Basics; Matlab; Applied Statistics and Software (Stata); Web Scrapy (Python)
- **University of California, Berkeley** **GPA:** 3.96/4.00
  Berkeley International Study Program, *January 2022 – December 2022*
  Selected Coursework: Math: Introduction to Analysis; Linear Modeling; Graduate Statistics for Program Evaluation; **Econ:** Topics in Economic Research; Global Inequality and Growth; Development Economics

SKILLS

· **Stata:** Proficient; · **Python & R:** Intermediate · **MATLAB & ArcGIS:** Coursework · **LaTeX& MS Office:** Intermediate · **Research Skills:** Big Data Analysis; Economic Modeling; Machine Learning; Literature Review

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Household Finance; Development Economics; Labor Market Inequality; Chinese Economy

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- **Empirical Research Fellow** at Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University *June 2025 - Present*
  Work with *Prof. Jacopo Ponticelli* and *Prof. Sean Higgins*.
- **Part-time Research Fellow** at Hunan University *July 2023 - June 2024*
  Work with *Prof. Weiguang Deng* on his National Natural Science Foundation Project (No. 72473038)
  · Cleaned and merged large-scale survey data (China Household Finance Survey).
  · Contributed to the design of causal inference using a Regression Discontinuity Design (RDD) approach.
  · Estimated model using Stata and conducted rigorous robustness checks.
- **Research Assistant** at Institute of Economics, CASS *March 2021 – July 2023*
  Work with *Prof. Qunhui Huang* (PI), *Prof. Wenshu Gao* (PI), and *Prof. Chi Zhang* on several projects.
  1. Applying Input-Output Analysis to Measure Inequality
  · Built a dataset on China's domestic trade and labor market from statistical yearbooks and crawling official websites, also cleaned and prepared the collected data for analysis.
  · Collaborated in design of causal inference strategy to evaluate the impact of domestic trade on income inequality.
  2. Frontiers Report on Political Economy (2022)
  · Completed literature and data collection, and also contributed to the composition of the literature review.

RECENT PROJECTS & PAPERS

- **Can Personal Income Tax Cut Motivate People to Get Married?** Working in progress
  · Using micro-level data from CHFS and employing an RD design, this paper finds that tax cuts significantly increase the probability of marriage among low-income women

- **Invisible Barriers——Gender Wage Gap in Domestic Immigrants in China** Working Paper
  Independent Study & Undergraduate's Thesis - Supervised by Prof. Qiong Wang & Abdoulaye Cisse
  · Estimated the gender wage gap among individuals in China who transitioned from rural to urban Hukou status.
  · Uncovered significant disparities where male immigrants earn wages equivalent to native urban male residents, while women continue to face considerably lower wages compared to their counterparts.
  · Discovered the dynamic effects of the migration years and hetereogeneity in income-levels.

- **International Students in China Promote China's Trade?** Unpublished Paper
  Independent Study – Supervised by Prof. Weiwei Wang, November 2021 – November 2023
  2023 National College Student Innovation and Entrepreneurship Training Program, October 2023 – May 2024
  · Employed Shift-Share IV to identify trade promotion effects brought by international students in China.
  · Proposed distinctive trade promotion mechanism, highlighting contributions of self-funded & international students taking elite training programs.

ACADEMIC SEMINAR PARTICIPATION

· 2024: **UChicago**: MA Workshop; **Sun Yat-sen University**: National Development Economics Conference for College Students
· 2023: **Peking University**: Econ Dept. Students' Conference; National Youth Forum on Economic Development
· 2022: **UC Berkeley**: Upper-level Undergraduate Research Workshop for Selected Papers

OTHER ACADEMIC ENGAGEMENTS

· **Peking University** Summer School for Educational Economics, *July 2023*
Best Participation Award, Best Cooperation Award
· **Yale University** Summer Session, *August 2021*
Academic Writing & Speaking: Postgraduate Seminar **Grade: A**
· **Teaching Assistant** at UCASS
Political Economy For *Prof. Chi Zhang, Fall 2021* & Intro to Econometrics For *Prof. Qiong Wang, Spring 2023*

GRANTS, AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

· **Gargoyle Research Scholarship and M.A. Director's Scholarship** *at UChicago, 2024, $6,000*
· **National Development Economics Conference for College Students**, *2024, ¥5,000*
Invisible Barriers——Gender Wage Gap in Domestic Immigrants, First Prize (Top 1%)
· **National College Student Innovation and Entrepreneurship Training Program**, *2023, ¥20,000*
International Students in China and Their Trade Promotion Effects
· **Undergraduate Research Grant** SOE's Reform and Its Stock Market Performance *at UCASS, 2021, ¥4,000*
· **Excellent Paper Award** Third Prize (Top 3%), Tongde Academic Forum for Students *at SUFE, 2023, ¥1,000*
· **Outstanding Student's Studying Abroad Scholarship** *at UCASS, 2021 & 2024*
For BISP at UC Berkeley (*2021, ¥120,000*) & MAPSS-Econ at UChicago (*2024, ¥50,000*)
· **Scholarship for Mathematical Modelling Winners** *at UCASS, 2022*
For **Finalist (top2%)** in the Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling (COMAP/MAA)
· **Academic Excellence Scholarship** *at UCASS, 2020 & 2021*

NON-ACADEMIC TALKS

· **TEDxYouth** at *Tianjin Duolun Road, November 2017* **Topic:** *Sharing Economy, Inequality, and Regulations*
· **Berkeley International Study Program Alumni Panel**, *November 2022*

PUBLIC SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

· **Camphor Economist Society in China**, *July, 2021 - Present*
Trained at Summer School in *July 2021*; Intern as Online Public Account Editor from *March 2022 to April 2024*
Staff Writer from *March 2022 - Present*; Won Best Editor Prize in *2023*.
· **UCASS Graduate School Application Mentor**, *September, 2024 - Present*

Language: Mandarin: Native; **English**: Proficient Last Updated: Jan 2026